

Frames Practice — Argument Builder Reference

How to use this sheet: Before you record, identify your frame. Work through the three questions left to right — your response must address all three. A response that skips the middle question is incomplete. The middle column is where most responses fall short.

W1 Scale & Stakeholder

Stakeholder <i>Who is affected and at what level?</i>	Impact <i>What specifically happens to them?</i>	Scale Consideration <i>Why does operating at that level change the argument?</i>
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W2 Trade-offs & Constraints

Benefit <i>What does the policy achieve?</i>	Trade-off <i>What competing good is sacrificed?</i>	Constraint <i>Why can't the trade-off simply be avoided?</i>
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W3 Causal Systems

Trigger <i>What sets the causal chain in motion?</i>	Mechanism <i>How does the effect actually get produced?</i>	Downstream Effect <i>What results at the end of the chain?</i>
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W4 Hypothetical & Conditional

Condition <i>What condition must hold for this scenario to follow?</i>	Projected Outcome <i>What would likely result?</i>	Extended Scenario <i>And if that outcome holds, then what?</i>
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W5 Values, Heuristics & Bias

Value <i>What does this stakeholder believe is important?</i>	Assumption <i>What must be true for that value to justify their position?</i>	Competing Framework <i>What does a stakeholder on the other side believe instead?</i>
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W6 Synthesis & Judgment

Tensions <i>What competing claims must be addressed?</i>	Priorities <i>Which consideration carries more weight and why?</i>	Judgment <i>What is the most defensible conclusion?</i>
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Remember: Naming a trade-off, a mechanism, a projected outcome, an assumption, or a priority — and explaining *why* — is what separates an ILR 2+ response from an ILR 3 one. Scaffold feedback is diagnostic only. Your score is always holistic.